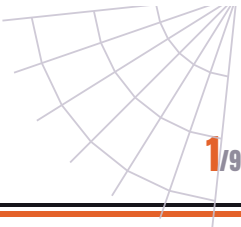


TRICK, TREAT, PLAN.



THE NIGHT

Party for

Date

Doors Ends

Where

Theme

Dress code

Adults Kids

Budget

RSVP by

Playlist by

Who is helping

HANDED TO SOMEONE ELSE

Nobody hosts and answers the door

SCARE LEVEL

Decide it now; everything follows

☐

☐

☐

☐

☐

Giggles and glitter

Genuinely frightening

THE ONE IMAGE PEOPLE SHOULD REMEMBER

COUNTDOWN

- ☐ 4 weeks
- ☐ 2 weeks
- ☐ 1 week
- ☐ The eve
- ☐ 31 October
- ☐ 1 November

NOTES

FOUR WEEKS TO THE NIGHT.



FOUR WEEKS OUT

- ☐ Set the date, the budget and the scare level
- ☐ Send the invitations – costumes need notice
- ☐ Order or start making costumes
- ☐ Book anything that gets booked out in October
- ☐ Decide: party, trick-or-treat, or both
- ☐
- ☐

ONE WEEK OUT

- ☐ Chase the guests who have not replied
- ☐ Buy pumpkins – not earlier, they collapse
- ☐ Batteries, tea lights, LED candles
- ☐ Print the playlist and the games
- ☐ Clear a room for coats and one for quiet
- ☐
- ☐

31 OCTOBER

- ☐ Food out late, so it is not warm and sad
- ☐ Porch light on means sweets, off means done
- ☐ Photos before the make-up melts
- ☐

TWO WEEKS OUT

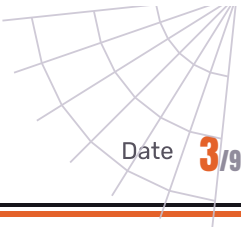
- ☐ Buy decorations before the good ones go
- ☐ Plan the menu and the drinks
- ☐ Buy the sweets – and hide them from yourself
- ☐ Test the lights, the fog machine, the speaker
- ☐ Ask about allergies on the RSVP
- ☐
- ☐

THE NIGHT BEFORE

- ☐ Carve the pumpkins
- ☐ Chill the drinks, make ice
- ☐ Hang everything that is not food
- ☐ Charge the camera and the speaker
- ☐ Lay out costumes and the make-up
- ☐
- ☐

- ☐ Light the pumpkins at dusk
- ☐ One person on the door, one on the camera
- ☐

WHO IS COMING AS WHAT.



GUESTS _____ The costume column stops two people arriving as the same thing

#	NAME	COMING AS	INV	YES	NO	+	ALLERGIES & NOTES
01	_____	_____	☐	☐	☐	_____	_____
02	_____	_____	☐	☐	☐	_____	_____
03	_____	_____	☐	☐	☐	_____	_____
04	_____	_____	☐	☐	☐	_____	_____
05	_____	_____	☐	☐	☐	_____	_____
06	_____	_____	☐	☐	☐	_____	_____
07	_____	_____	☐	☐	☐	_____	_____
08	_____	_____	☐	☐	☐	_____	_____
09	_____	_____	☐	☐	☐	_____	_____
10	_____	_____	☐	☐	☐	_____	_____
11	_____	_____	☐	☐	☐	_____	_____
12	_____	_____	☐	☐	☐	_____	_____
13	_____	_____	☐	☐	☐	_____	_____
14	_____	_____	☐	☐	☐	_____	_____
15	_____	_____	☐	☐	☐	_____	_____
16	_____	_____	☐	☐	☐	_____	_____
17	_____	_____	☐	☐	☐	_____	_____
18	_____	_____	☐	☐	☐	_____	_____
19	_____	_____	☐	☐	☐	_____	_____
20	_____	_____	☐	☐	☐	_____	_____
21	_____	_____	☐	☐	☐	_____	_____
22	_____	_____	☐	☐	☐	_____	_____

_____	INVITED	_____	COMING	_____	CAN'T	_____	WAITING	_____	KIDS
-------	---------	-------	--------	-------	-------	-------	---------	-------	------

COSTUMES & PRIZES.



THE HOUSEHOLD ————— What is bought, what is still missing

WHO	GOING AS	GOT IT	STILL NEEDED
_____	_____	☐	_____
_____	_____	☐	_____
_____	_____	☐	_____
_____	_____	☐	_____
_____	_____	☐	_____
_____	_____	☐	_____

MAKE-UP AND HAIR ————— Who does it, and how long it takes

REPAIR KIT BY THE MIRROR —————

- ☐ Safety pins, tape, a needle and thread
- ☐ Wipes, and the make-up used for touch-ups
- ☐ Plasters – the shoes are always the problem
- ☐ Spare tights, socks, a hair grip or six

TEST THE WHOLE COSTUME ONCE ————— In a mirror, sitting down

☐ _____

THE CONTEST ————— Announce the categories on the invitation

CATEGORY	WINNER	PRIZE
Best costume	_____	_____
Funniest	_____	_____
Most frightening	_____	_____
Best homemade	_____	_____
Best group	_____	_____
Best last-minute effort	_____	_____

JUDGING ————— Decide before the drinks

Judged by _____

Announced at _____

Prizes bought by _____

PHOTO PLAN ————— The costumes are the reason people came

☐ _____

☐ _____

☐ _____

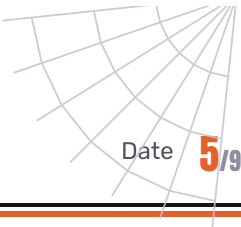
FOR WHOEVER TURNS UP IN NORMAL CLOTHES —————

☐ _____

☐ _____

☐ _____

FOOD THAT LOOKS WRONG.



SAVOURY

————— Name it on a card — half the fun is the label

WHAT IT IS

WHO MAKES IT

_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____

SWEET

WHAT IT IS

WHO MAKES IT

_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____

SWEETS FOR THE DOOR

————— Count on more children than last year

Bags _____

Spare bags _____

DRINKS

————— One punch bowl saves an hour of pouring

WHAT

HOW MUCH

_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____

Two things to get right

Dry ice goes **in the bowl around the punch, never in the drink**, and never in a sealed bottle. And if there are children, keep an alcohol-free punch that looks just as good — on a night of identical black cups, that matters.

ALLERGIES

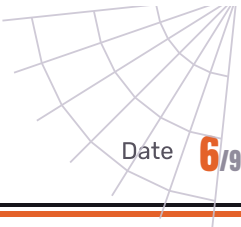
————— Copy them from the guest list

_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐

ICE, CUPS AND THE BIT EVERYONE FORGETS

- ☐ More ice than seems sensible
- ☐ Cups people can tell apart, or a pen to name them
- ☐ Bin bags out early, one for bottles

DARK, BUT YOU CAN SEE.



ROOM BY ROOM _____ One idea each is plenty

WHERE	WHAT HAPPENS THERE	DONE
Doorway and path	_____	☐
Hall	_____	☐
Main room	_____	☐
Kitchen	_____	☐
Table	_____	☐
Bathroom	_____	☐
Garden	_____	☐

LIGHT _____ The whole effect is lighting; the rest is props

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

OUTSIDE, WHERE PEOPLE ARRIVE _____

- ☐ The path lit, the step visible
- ☐ A sign if the door is hard to find
- ☐ Nothing that blows over or trips people

SOUND _____

- Playlist _____
- Starts quiet at _____
- Speaker & charger _____

Before anyone arrives

Real candles go where nobody walks and nothing hangs – LED tea lights everywhere else, especially inside pumpkins and near costumes. Check that the stairs and the path are lit even if the rest is dark, and put the breakables away rather than around.

PUT AWAY BEFORE THE NIGHT _____

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

ANYTHING WITH A PLUG OR A FOG BUTTON _____

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

THE ENTRANCE _____ The first ten seconds do most of the work

- _____
- _____
- _____

PUMPKINS.



THE PLAN ————— Who carves what, and where it ends up

#	WHOSE	DESIGN	CUT	GOES
1	_____	_____	☐	_____
2	_____	_____	☐	_____
3	_____	_____	☐	_____
4	_____	_____	☐	_____
5	_____	_____	☐	_____
6	_____	_____	☐	_____
7	_____	_____	☐	_____
8	_____	_____	☐	_____
9	_____	_____	☐	_____
10	_____	_____	☐	_____

Buy on _____ Carve on _____

Carved pumpkins last about three days indoors and about five outside in the cold. Carving on the 28th is early. Carving on the 30th is right.

IF NOBODY WANTS A KNIFE NEAR IT —————

- ☐ Painted instead of cut – lasts a fortnight
- ☐ Drilled dots, a light behind them
- ☐ Three stacked, tallest at the back

WHAT YOU NEED —————

- ☐ Serrated knife or a carving saw
- ☐ Big spoon or scoop
- ☐ Marker for drawing the face on first
- ☐ Newspaper, and a bin bag ready
- ☐ LED tea lights, not real ones
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

THE INSIDES ————— Nobody plans this and everybody regrets it

- ☐ Seeds kept, rinsed and roasted
- ☐ The rest into the garden or the food waste

SKETCH THE FACES HERE ————— You are copying it onto a curve



Set-up at the top, taxis at the bottom

WHAT HAPPENS

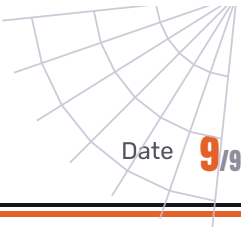
WHO IS ON IT

Write the time next to each

- 1 Set up finished**
Nothing left to hang after the first guest
- 2 Doors, drinks, photographs**
The costumes are freshest now
- 3 Food out**
Later than feels right
- 4 Games, or the contest**
One thing, well timed
- 5 Prizes announced**
Before anyone starts leaving
- 6 Music up, lights lower**
The party either lifts here or ends here
- 7 Last drinks, taxis, coats**
Say the time out loud

- ☐ Porch light on, bowl filled, path lit
- ☐ Someone at home while the others walk
- ☐ Torch, phone, and a bag that will not split
- ☐ Route agreed, and the time you turn back
- ☐ Check the sweets before the small ones eat them

THE FIRST OF NOVEMBER.



WHAT WORKED – Write it now; next October you will not remember

WHAT TO DO DIFFERENTLY

THE COSTUMES: KEEP, MEND OR PASS ON

Today, not next year

Decorations, costumes and sweets are half price from today. Buy next year’s this afternoon, put it in one labelled box, and write on the lid what is inside. It is the single cheapest thing on this page.

BOUGHT IN THE SALES, IN THE BOX

☐

☐

☐

☐

☐

PHOTOS TO SEND TO PEOPLE

WHERE THE BOX LIVES

NEXT YEAR, ONE LINE – Worth ten written in September